



KENYA

Capital city: Nairobi**Area:** 224,961 sq miles (582,650 sq km)**Population:** 32,000,000**Official language:** Kiswahili, English**Major religions:** Christian 60%, traditional beliefs 25%, Muslim 6%, other 9%**Government:** Multiparty democracy**Currency:** Kenya shilling**Adult literacy rate:** 84%**Life expectancy:** 46 years**People per doctor:** 10,000

KENYA

UNLIKE MANY AFRICAN countries, Kenya has been stable and relatively democratic since it gained its independence from Britain in 1963. Under British rule, large farms were created in many areas to produce cash crops, and a network of roads and railroads was built to link ports and towns. Today, Kenya is one of Africa's richest countries, producing crops such as coffee and tea for export, and welcoming tourists to its vast game reserves. Side-by-side with this, many people still make their living from small farms or cattle herding. Kenya has one of the world's fastest growing populations, which has led to increasing poverty, rivalry over land, and some ethnic violence.

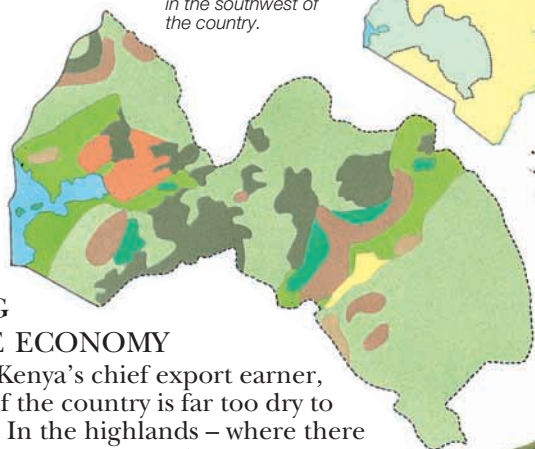
Kenya's main crops

The main farming area, shown enlarged on the map below, is in the southwest of the country.



On game reserves such as Kenya's Masai Mara and Amboseli National Park, tourists can photograph wild animals close up.

- Coffee
- Tea
- Sisal
- Sugarcane
- Rice
- Forest
- Other



Tea

Coffee beans

Green beans

FARMING AND THE ECONOMY

Farming is Kenya's chief export earner, but much of the country is far too dry to grow crops. In the highlands – where there is more rain – tea, coffee, wheat, corn, sisal, and sugarcane are grown. Where less water is available, dairy and meat cattle are farmed on large ranches. Dams and lakes provide water to irrigate land for growing market garden crops, such as green beans, which are exported by air to foreign supermarkets.



KENYAN PEOPLES

These villagers belong to Kenya's largest tribe, the Kikuyu, who live around Kirinyaga (Mount Kenya). The Kikuyu god, Ngai, is believed to live on the mountain, so the Kikuyu traditionally built their houses with the doors facing the mountain. Like two-thirds of the country's 70 tribal groups, the Kikuyu speak Bantu. Small numbers of Asians, Arabs, and Europeans also live in Kenya.



NAIROBI

Lions, giraffes, and cheetahs roam the plains that surround Kenya's capital, Nairobi, with the skyscrapers of the modern city as a backdrop. This is the largest city in eastern Africa, with a population of about 3 million people. It developed after European colonization as a convenient stopping place on the railroad from Uganda to Kenya's main port of Mombasa.



TOURISM

Tropical beaches and some of Africa's best game reserves attract thousands of tourists to Kenya. Tourism is vital to the country's economy, and the government has invested in roads, airports, and hotels to make Kenya one of the easiest and most comfortable African countries for tourists to visit. Because most people come to see the animals on game reserves, the government has placed a high priority on protecting wildlife and stamping out poaching.

KENYAN ATHLETES

Athletes from Kenya's Rift Valley area excel at running long distances. They have won the gold medal in the Olympic 3,000 m steeplechase events in five recent Olympic Games, and Kenyan Moses Kiptanui was the first man to run the 3,000 m steeplechase in under eight minutes. The runners' skill may stem from the high altitude they live and train in, or from years of running long distances to school.



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